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Documents

1) Smeets, S., Beach, D.

The Institutional Ingredients of Polycrisis Management: Unpacking European Council's Handling of the Energy Crisis
(2023) *Politics and Governance*, 11 (4), pp. 275-285. Cited 2 times.

Abstract
This article analyses how the European Council and the institutional infrastructure that supports it have been managing the early stages of the energy crisis. This was the time when the European Council, as the "control room" of EU crisis management, was unable to come up with any solutions to high energy prices. It makes a methodological and empirical contribution to the debate on how the European Council system manages (poly)crises. Methodologically, we introduce the method of embedded process tracing to study EU crisis management from within. Embedded process tracing combines mainstream causal process tracing techniques with elements from interpretivist approaches, to deal with context dependency, case heterogeneity, and empirical density. Empirically, we offer a process-management analysis of the first nine months of the energy crisis. We delineate the roles of various actors and institutions: the president of the European Council, the Council Secretariat, the Commission president, and the Commission Services. We unpack the crucial ingredients of polycrisis management: how to get and keep an issue on the agenda, how to shape and steer European-Council-level debates and conclusions, and how to ensure a proper follow-up by the Commission and the Council. Finally, we re-assess the image of the malfunctioning control room and show the causal relevance of the European Council's early performance. © 2023 by the author(s); licensee Cogitatio Press (Lisbon, Portugal).

Author Keywords
energy crisis; EU institutions; European Council; polycrisis; process management

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2) Schramm, L., Wessels, W.

The European Council as a crisis manager and fusion driver: assessing the EU's fiscal response to the COVID-19 pandemic
(2023) *Journal of European Integration*, 45 (2), pp. 257-273. Cited 10 times.

Abstract
As with previous crises, the European Union's (EU) reaction to the COVID-19 pandemic has again highlighted the European Council's pivotal role in the EU's institutional architecture and development. In creating the 'Next Generation EU' recovery package in July 2020, it provided the Union's main instrument for coping with economic damage resulting from the pandemic. In both the run-up to and aftermath of this history-making decision, the European Council acted as the driver of a horizontal and vertical fusion of responsibilities: horizontally, it instructed and partly relied on other EU institutions; vertically, it satisfied and further developed close links between the EU and national levels of government. Scrutinising the different phases of a policymaking cycle (preparation, decision, implementation, control), this article highlights and puts into perspective the European Council's key activities at each stage. © 2022 The Author(s). Published by Informa UK Limited, trading as Taylor & Francis Group.

Author Keywords
Covid-19; crisis; European Council; fusion model; NGEU

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3) Fabbrini, S., Puetter, U.

Integration without supranationalisation: studying the lead roles of the European Council and the Council in post-Lisbon EU politics
(2016) *Journal of European Integration*, 38 (5), pp. 481-495. Cited 84 times.

Abstract
Abstract: This special issue follows up on a stream of recent contributions on what has been identified as a particular phase of post-Maastricht European integration: the ‘new intergovernmentalism’ and ‘the intergovernmental union’. This literature considers the European Union’s (EU) core intergovernmental forums for policy coordination, the European Council, the Eurogroup and the Foreign Affairs Council as central to EU decision-making. These bodies perform functions related to policy initiation and implementation which were traditionally associated with the European Commission. Intergovernmentalisation is primarily detectable in new areas of EU activity such as economic governance and foreign affairs which operate mainly outside the community method and in policy sectors which depict a mix of legislative and non-legislative decision-making mechanisms, such as justice and home affairs and energy. More integration is achieved without significant further supranationalisation. These developments affect how the Union’s main decision bodies operate and how interinstitutional relations are structured. © 2016 Informa UK Limited, trading as Taylor & Francis Group.

Author Keywords
Council; European Council; Integration; intergovernmentalism; supranationalism

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4) Puetter, U.

Europe's deliberative intergovernmentalism: The role of the Council and European Council in EU economic governance
(2012) *Journal of European Public Policy*, 19 (2), pp. 161-178. Cited 247 times.

Abstract
The European Union's (EU's) responses to the economic and financial crisis provided a vigorous illustration for how the role of the Union's core intergovernmental bodies - the European Council and the Council - has evolved in recent years. The European Council has emerged as the centre of political gravity in the field of economic governance. The Council and the Eurogroup fulfil a crucial role as forums for policy debate. The emphasis on increased high-level intergovernmental policy co-ordination is the reflection of an integration paradox inherent to the post-Maastricht EU. While policy interdependencies have grown, member state governments have resisted the further transfer of formal competences to the EU level and did not follow the model of the Community method. Instead, they aim for greater policy coherence through intensified intergovernmental co-ordination. Given its consensus dependency, this co-ordination system can best be conceptualized as deliberative intergovernmentalism. © 2012 Copyright Taylor and Francis Group, LLC.

Author Keywords
Council; deliberation; Economic and Monetary Union; European Council; intergovernmentalism; policy co-ordination

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